



Mystery crystal

This crystal behaves both as an insulator and conductor. Find out more about the crystal here: <http://dgit.in/paradoxcry>



The machines behind music

Love Music? Here are some interesting devices that were used to make music in the 19th century: <http://dgit.in/oldelectronica>

Feature

stables. You get great build quality, in-line controls, and a signature that's tuned to reproduce great highs. If you like your music with an extra serving of bass, you'd better avoid these. But if you're one of those audiophiles who'd appreciate the ear piercing pinch harmonics from a Stratocaster, these are worth your money.

Price: ₹999

Cowon EK2

The EK2 is your weapon of choice if you have a bit more money to spend and are looking for an upgrade over the old favourite EM1. You'll find that the EK2 differs slightly in terms of its sound signature. The EK2 is sharper and at the same time provides a better seal than the



EM1. It's also more sensitive, so you get more volume per unit of input power. At the end of it the EK2 adheres to a simple formula: throw a little more money, get a little more performance. If the EM1 is ever discontinued, the EK2 is a prime candidate for being our go-to recco for the foreseeable future.

Price: ₹1,099

Creative HITZ MA350

Perhaps one of the most underrated IEMs around, the MA350 seems to have slipped under the amateur audiophile's radar. These earphones sport a flat tangle-free cable just like the Cowon EM1 but gain a few points in the features department thanks to the sliding volume control switch (most likely an in-line pot, thus working with any source). Performance-wise too they're slightly ahead giving you crystal clear mids and highs without the



flatlining bass of the EM1. Recommended for bass-heads who want fidelity in other frequency ranges. The rated frequency response on this pair of IEMs is 6Hz ~ 23kHz. Of course we don't really believe it's going to go as low as 6Hz but it's still an indicator of its tuning.

Price: ₹1,370

Tekfusion Twinwoofers

These are made by an Indian company based out of Bangalore. As far as IEMs go, they're not bad at all. True to their name the Twinwoofers are bass heavy and there is more emphasis on upper mids as well. There's good clarity in the entire range but



cord microphonics is a bit of an issue. The fit and isolation could've been better but the build quality of the housing is decent. The different ear tips provided are a nice touch. If you're a bass head you won't go wrong with these.

Price: ₹1,449

JBL Synchros E10

The Synchros E10 brings in the perfect balance between style, sportiness and great sound. The IEM has the typical JBL

sound signature – well represented mids and highs with an over-load on bass. In terms of performance, it's got what you would need – clarity, tonal accuracy and a decent soundstage. In terms of features, it hits the right spots as well with its flat, tangle free cable and a see-through box it comes in that doubles as a carry case. Between this and the Soundmagic E10S that we talk about next, you should go for this one if you prefer bass.

Price: ₹1,999

SoundMAGIC E10S

The E10S has perhaps the best aural performance on this list. At first glance they appear to be an exact replica of the legendary E10 but they're not. There's a small change in headphone's wiring – a switch near the headphone jack that makes it compatible with a number of smartphone variants. And unlike the E10, there's no on-cable volume control, instead there's just a single toggle. The



sound reproduction is crystal clear as expected but is a little warmer than the E10M. The bass is hard-hitting (giving it a broader audience) and the cable is braided unlike the delicate, almost flimsy string of a cable on the E10. All these enhancements and it costs about ₹200 less than the E10 which makes them a good choice.

Price: ₹2,049